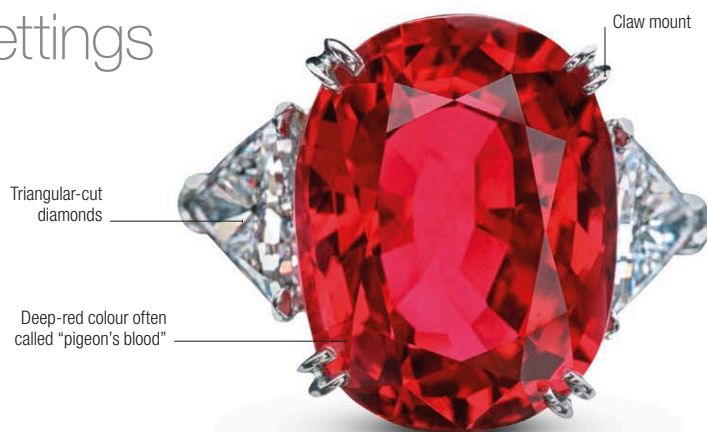


Settings



Carmen Lúcia Ruby | At 23.10 carats, this is the largest faceted ruby in the United States National Gem Collection. It is also one of the finest large, faceted Burmese rubies known. High-quality Burmese rubies larger than 20 carats are exceedingly rare. The stone was mined from the fabled Mogok region of Myanmar in the 1930s.

52 square-cut rubies

46 round diamonds



Floral brooch | This intricate gold brooch takes the form of a spray of flowers, set with rubies and sapphires (both varieties of corundum) and diamonds.



Gold ring | The unusual hexagonal bezel on this ring is set with two rows of rubies, two rows of diamonds, and a large central diamond.

Platinum setting



1930s earrings | A total of 64 calibre-cut rubies are set in this ribbon and circle motif, with two central round-cut diamonds and 34 more baguette and round-cut diamonds.

Diamond trimming



Navette ring | Dating from around 1910, this Edwardian platinum and gold ring is topped with a diamond-set flower in a field of rubies framed with diamonds.



Dragon pendant | In keeping with ancient traditions, this pendant takes the form of a dragon with a ruby for an eye. The setting consists of white gold and diamonds.



Ruby and diamond ring | The pendeloque ruby set in this platinum ring, surrounded by 10 diamonds, has the slight purple tint called "pigeon's blood".

Red gemstones

What's in a name?

The name "ruby" has been applied to a number of red gemstones throughout history including garnets (see pp.258–63) and spinels (see pp.80–81) – Balas ruby was once another name for spinel. It was only through the development of chemistry and mineralogy in the 19th century that distinctions could be scientifically made. Today, many rubies are heat treated to improve their clarity or colour. There are also synthetic rubies available, but their value is a tiny fraction of the real thing.

Stepped cut created for emeralds to show off colour



Emerald-cut synthetic Despite the good colour and clarity typical of synthetic rubies, their value is low.